PRODUCT CASE STUDY

Automated Workflows

How a single client request became a platform-wide workflow engine serving businesses across the Middle East & India

Document Renewals | Multi-level Approvals | Auto HRMS Updates | Tiered Subscription Model

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02 The Problem

ORIGIN

A Middle East client request that revealed a platform-wide gap

A client in the Middle East was managing employee visa, passport, and work authorization renewals manually in Excel resulting in missing deadlines, manual follow ups, and updating greytHR records manually after each renewal cycle.

They asked for an "Excel-like table" inside greytHR.

After a direct client call, it became clear: they didn’t need a table. They needed an end-to-end automated workflow.

Insight: Reframed solution request into the real underlying problem

Missed Renewal Deadlines

Manual Excel tracking caused delays in visa and passport renewals, putting employees' work eligibility and payroll at risk.

Multi-level Approvals via Email

Collecting approvals and documents from multiple stakeholders — including third parties — was manual, slow, untracked, and error-prone.

Manual HRMS Updates

After each renewal, admins had to manually re-enter updated details in greytHR — affecting payroll and employee eligibility if delayed.

No Audit Trail

No centralised record of who approved what, when — creating compliance risk for a regulation-heavy region like the Middle East.

03

My Role & Process

Team: PM + 4–6 Engineers · Timeline: 2 Months

Key PM Decision: Rather than building a one-off solution for one client, I cross-referenced support tickets and interviewed multiple customers — identifying a platform-wide need and scaling the solution via a tiered subscription model.

1	2	3	4	5	6
Discovery	**Pattern Analysis**	**Validate**	**Refine & Align**	**Build & Test**	**Launch & Tier**
Direct client call Reframed 'table' to 'workflow' Identified real need	Mined support tickets Interviewed multiple Clients Confirmed platform gap	Received pushback initiatially. Thus, built mockup design Ran scenarios with the Client	Tested with multiple customers + internal HR team Client approved	Led squad of 4–6 Built trigger engine, approval layers, auto HRMS sync	Designed tier model Basic → Premium Rolled out to all clients

04

Validation — Turning Pushback Into Proof

The client pushed back — our proposed workflow didn’t match their mental model. Here’s how we resolved it.

1

Built a Mockup

Instead of arguing the case in words, we created a high-fidelity mockup of the proposed workflow — showing the client exactly how their visa and passport renewal process would work end-to-end inside greytHR.

2

Ran Multi-Stakeholder Scenarios

We walked the client through real-world scenarios using the mockup. We also tested with other customers and our own internal HR team — identifying gaps and edge cases before a single line of code was written.

3

Client Signed Off

After seeing the workflow handle their scenarios accurately and hearing feedback from other users, the client was convinced. The mockup became the blueprint — validated, refined, and ready to build.

PM Principle: Never argue a reframe — show it. A mockup does more convincing in 10 minutes than a presentation does in an hour.

05 The Solution

A fully customizable, event-triggered workflow engine — set up once, runs automatically forever.

Admin sets up workflow once

Trigger fires automatically (before/on/after event)

Notifications sent to each reviewer level in sequence

Custom forms & documents collected per reviewer level

HRMS auto-updated once all approvals are complete

SUPPORTED WORKFLOW EVENTS

- Visa / Passport Expiry
- Work Authorization Renewal
- Employee Confirmation
- Employee Exit
- Driving License Renewal
- Birthday & Custom Events (Premium)

PACKAGING MODEL

Basic	Core workflows included
Tier 2	+3 additional workflow events
Tier 3	+3 additional workflow events
Premium	All events, full customization

06

Outcome & Learnings

120

New workflows created within 1 Month

~60%

Reduction in manual HR admin follow-ups

2

Months discovery to full launch

120 workflows created in Month 1, strong adoption was seen. Adoption grew steadily as customers migrated to the upgraded system. ~60% reduction in manual admin follow-up for events was observed in next 6 months indicating reduced manual intervention.

LEARNINGS

- A single client request, properly investigated, revealed a platform-wide opportunity — the real skill was asking ‘why’ before jumping to ‘what’
- When a client pushes back on your direction, don’t argue — show them. A mockup validated across multiple stakeholders does more than any slide deck
- Tiered subscription design required balancing small business needs with enterprise demands — pricing strategy is a core PM responsibility, not just a sales function